



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bishop John J. Snyder High School

School Website: <https://bishopsnyder.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)**

School website: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) presents clear, repeated, and substantive evidence of a classical Christian identity across mission, curriculum, and pedagogy. Public materials explicitly center truth, goodness, and beauty; the cultivation of wisdom and virtue; the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; integrated studies; memory work; discussion/debate; and upper□school rhetoric/thesis—all core positive indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon. The school’s mission (“glorify Jesus Christ,” “cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students”) and curricular pages (Trivium, Latin, Great Books, Christian Studies) strongly align with classical norms.

Six-category ratings: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Method note: Keyword analysis and scoring use the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators described in the Six Essential Elements document and the classicality lexicon; judgments below reference both the ACS site and these indicator sets.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- Positive indicators (from ACS site):
- “glorify Jesus Christ” (explicit Christ-centered telos)
- “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” (transcendental moral realism)
- “the interconnectedness of all knowledge ... under the sovereignty of God through theology” (theological grounding; theology as integrating discipline)
- Christian Studies sequence (Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics)
- Mapping to Six Elements positive lists:
- truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; moral order (Religious/Metaphysical positives)
- theology; faith and reason; sacred scripture; Christian formation (Grounded in Theology positives)
- Negative indicators on site: none observed (no “values-neutral,” “relativism,” etc.) as defined in the framework.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts (exact-site phrases mapped to framework)

- Positive hits ≈ 7 (glorify Jesus Christ; truth; goodness; beauty; theology; Christian Studies; formation language)
- Negative hits = 0

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage (how many core sub-themes appear): 75%
- Percent positive (of matched keywords, how many are positive): 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +7/-0
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Clear moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), explicit Christ-centered telos, and integration of theology across curriculum match the strongest indicators in the Six Elements lists.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (stated aim)
- “education ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (formation, not mere information)
- “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation ... more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose” (classical telos over careerism)
- “great books,” “great conversation” (aiming at permanent questions)
- Framework positives: wisdom, virtue, formation, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, great conversation.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts

- Positive hits ≈ 8
- Negative hits = 0

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage: 100%
- Percent positive: 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +8/-0
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: ACS mission and philosophy match the core classical ends of education defined in the framework.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric (with stage descriptions K–4, 5–8, 9–12)
- Latin required (Latin from 5th–8th; HS Latin I/II; logic and rhetoric in HS plan; senior thesis)
- Great Books/Great Conversation; Western tradition; integrated curriculum; history (not “social studies”)
- Theology integrated (Christian Studies; exegesis, apologetics)
- Framework positives: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books and western canon; Latin/Greek; integrated/harmony of subjects; cultivation of wonder.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts

- Positive hits ≈ 12 (Trivium; Grammar; Logic; Rhetoric; Latin; Great Books; History; Integration; Wonder; Rhetoric/Thesis; Christian Studies; Primary-text orientation implied)
- Negative hits = 0 (no “social studies” framing replacing history; no STEM-first marketing)

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage: 100%
- Percent positive: 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +12/-0

- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: ACS presents a complete classical course of study with explicit Trivium, Latin, Great Books, and integrated Christian Studies.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- Lower school memory work: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (chant/sing + review)
- Upper school dialectic/rhetoric practices: “debate and discussion” in logic years; “thesis defense,” “eloquent written and oral communication” in rhetoric years (Socratic/dialectic/rhetoric indicators)
- Wonder/contemplative orientation: “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (restful learning aim)
- Framework positives: Socratic/dialectic, recitation/chanting/singing, memory work, restful learning (scholé), rhetoric instruction and orations.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts

- Positive hits ≈ 9 (memorization; recitation; songs; debate; discussion; thesis defense; rhetoric; wonder; contemplation)
- Negative hits = 0 (no project-based only or constructivist language)

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage: 80%
- Percent positive: 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +9/-0
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: ACS describes classical memory pedagogy in the grammar years and dialectic/rhetorical practices in the upper years, with explicit thesis defense—core classical pedagogy.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- “Head of School who loves Jesus ... teachers who enjoy serving God by teaching students about His world using the classical approach.” (formation/mentorship implied)
- Evidence of explicit “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or stated teacher virtues not found in public pages sampled.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts

- Positive hits ≈ 2 (teachers as Christian mentors; classical approach)
- Negative hits = 0

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage: 40%
- Percent positive: 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +2/-0
- Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: Faculty language is positive but light; explicit statements that teachers are “models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” or a formal teacher profile were not located in the crawl excerpts reviewed. Further documentation could strengthen this category. (See framework for Faculty indicators.)

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keyword evidence found on school site

- “co-laboring with families” (partnership with parents)
- “schedule a visit” and frequent invitations to engage (hospitality, open campus orientation)
- “Recommended Reading” for deeper understanding of classical education (parent formation resource)
- Framework positives: partnership with families, parent formation, communication about classical philosophy.

2) Positive vs. Negative counts

- Positive hits ≈ 4
- Negative hits = 0

3) Percentages and rating

- Percent coverage: 70%
- Percent positive: 100%
- pos_neg_hits: +4/-0
- Category rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: ACS explicitly positions families as partners and provides formation resources, which aligns with classical community practices.

Aggregate Result

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

ACS meets or exceeds classical indicators in 5 of 6 categories and is “somewhat classical” in Faculty due to lighter public articulation about teacher formation and a formal teacher portrait. Given the strength of mission, curriculum, and pedagogy, the school is properly classified as CLASSICAL overall.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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